Day 66 (stop 1 of 2) - Spirit Rock, Wiarton

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Peninsula section · hike 86 · Wiarton and Spirit Rock

3.9 km / 2.4 mi	~1.4 h	3.2 km new	177 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive from home, Sat 7 am

Park: Off road parking at the end of Bayview Street. Google Maps.

Navigate: import *day66a_hike086.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Spirit Rock Side Trail (2.6 km); Wiarton Side Trail (0.6 km)

Same day: this is stop 1 of 2 on day 66 (5.2 mi of hiking, about 359 min total driving). Other stop(s): stop 2: hike 87, 2.7 mi from From Wiarton, take Bruce Rd 13 west for 2 km to Northacres Rd. Parking and access to....

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Off-road parking at the end of Bayview Street in Wiarton.
- **Spirit Rock Side Trail:** This trail passes the Corran ruins, the remains of a 17-room mansion Alexander McNeill built in 1881. Vandalism and fires later ruined it. The trail also passes the site of the Legend of Spirit Rock. Paths through Spirit Rock Conservation Area cross fields and forest, and an escarpment-top lookout gives wide views over Colpoy's Bay.
- **Spiral staircase:** A spiral staircase on the Bruce Trail winds down the cliff between the escarpment top and the rocky Colpoy's Bay shore. Take it slowly with Zappy, and stay back from the cliff edge at the lookout.
- **Wiarton Side Trail:** A short connector back toward town. We found no description of it.
- **Season:** Spirit Rock Conservation Area is open year-round, but its trails aren't groomed in winter.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Off road parking at the end of Bayview Street. Walk about 110 m to the trail. Head north-west on the blue-blazed Spirit Rock Side Trail.
1.5	0.9	J1: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off behind you.) There is trailhead parking here (Spirit Rock Conservation Area: Follow signs from Hwy 6). Then, turn right onto the blue-blazed Spirit Rock Side Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
2.6	1.6	J2: You pass the start again. Keep going on the blue-blazed Wiarton Side Trail, heading south-west.
2.9	1.8	Heads-up: The next 0.6 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
3.2	2.0	J3: Turnaround point. Turn around and retrace your steps.
3.9	2.4	Leave the trail and walk back to the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on blogTO, Ontario Nature Trails, Hike Bike Travel and the Vanderplas family's Bruce Trail journal.